

SPX Options Flow — Weekly Macro Briefing

Weekly Options Flow & Dealer Positioning Analysis

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▼ SHORT GAMMA

RISK: EXTREME

Composite Score: -0.50

SPX SPOT 6,625	NET GEX -3034.36B	GAMMA FLIP 7,205	DIST. TO FLIP -8.8%	CALL WALL #1 6,625	PUT WALL #1 6,625
MAX PAIN 6,690			VIX 27.03		

Dealers are in SHORT GAMMA with net GEX of \$-3034.37B. Spot (6,625) sits 8.8% below the gamma flip level (7,205). Composite macro score: -0.50 → Risk Level: EXTREME. Key risks: BEARISH_VOL_BUY, BELOW FLIP: BEARISH, OPEX 1DTE, DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW, BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY.

REGIME PLAYBOOK

▲ EQUITIES

Reduce net delta, buy downside puts for protection

◆ VOLATILITY

Long VIX, buy volatility — trend moves may persist

◆ OPTIONS STRATEGY

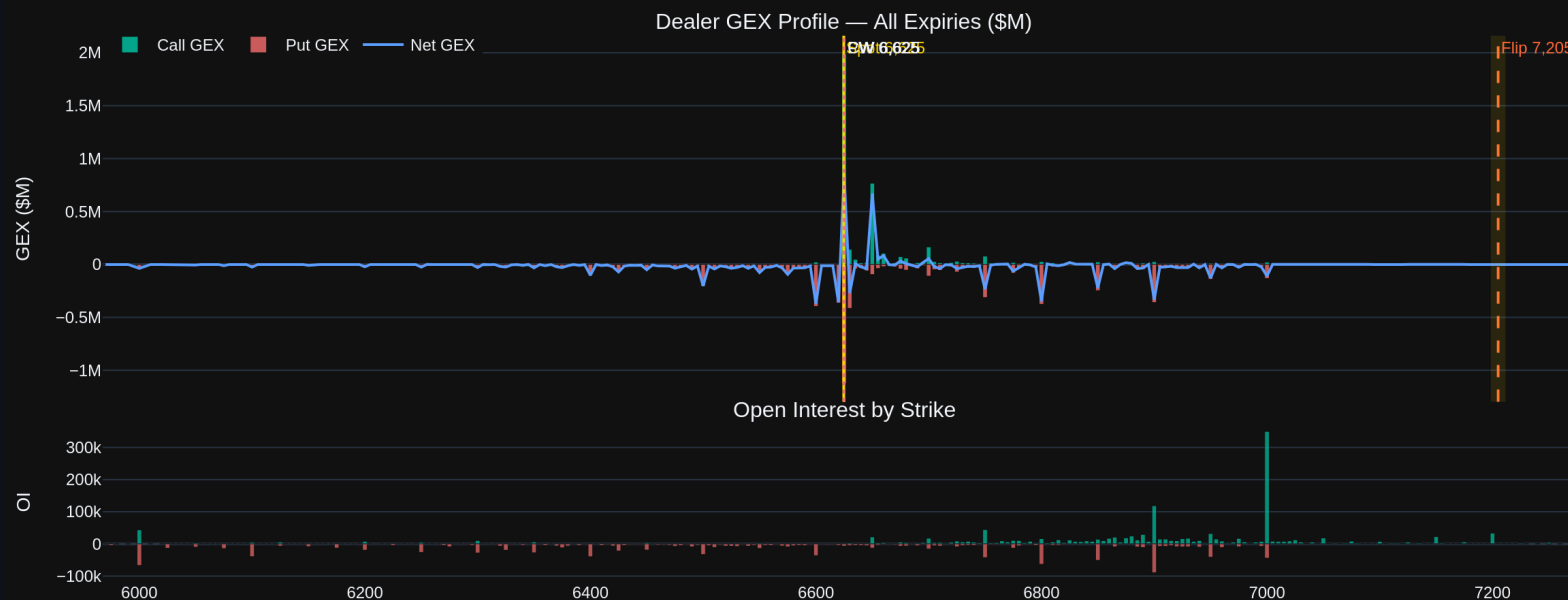
Long straddles, buy gamma for directional exposure

◆ POSITION SIZING

Reduce 30–50% — elevated tail risk in short-gamma regime

GEX Profile — Dealer Gamma Exposure

March 19, 2026



KEY LEVELS

STRIKE	TYPE	GEX (\$M)	DIST. FROM SPOT	INTERPRETATION
6,625	Call Wall	+1987959M	+0.0%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,650	Call Wall	+766655M	+0.4%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,700	Call Wall	+166039M	+1.1%	Strong resistance / dealer selling
6,625	Put Wall	-1124827M	+0.0%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure
6,630	Put Wall	-414388M	+0.1%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure
6,600	Put Wall	-396063M	-0.4%	Downside accelerator / dealer selling pressure

OPEX: 2026-03-20 (1 DTE)

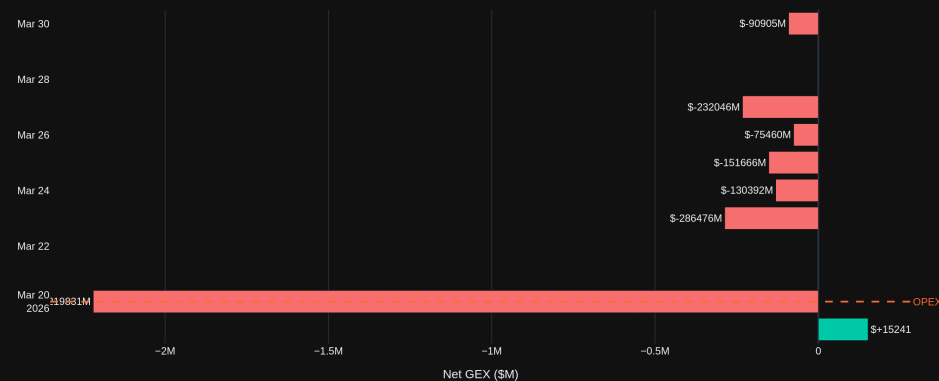
Net GEX Expiring	% of Total Book
\$-2219831M	73.2%

Expiry Roll-Off & Delta Exposure

March 19, 2026

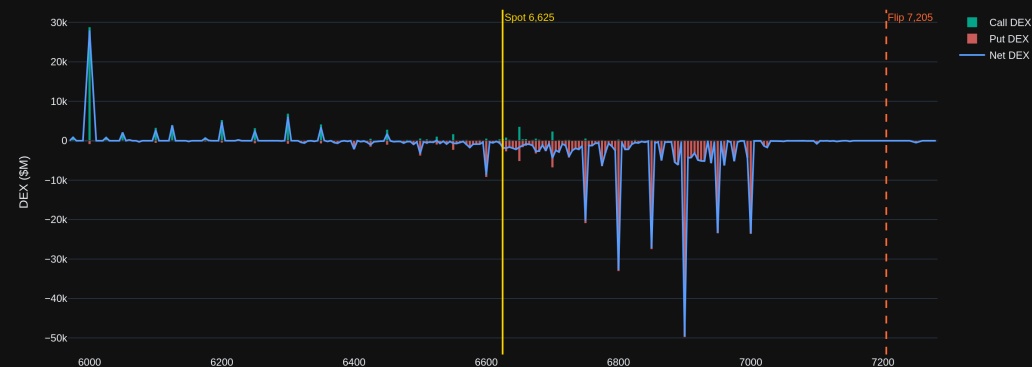
GEX BY EXPIRY

Net GEX by Expiry — Roll-Off Profile (\$M)



DEX PROFILE

Dealer Delta Exposure (DEX) by Strike (\$M)



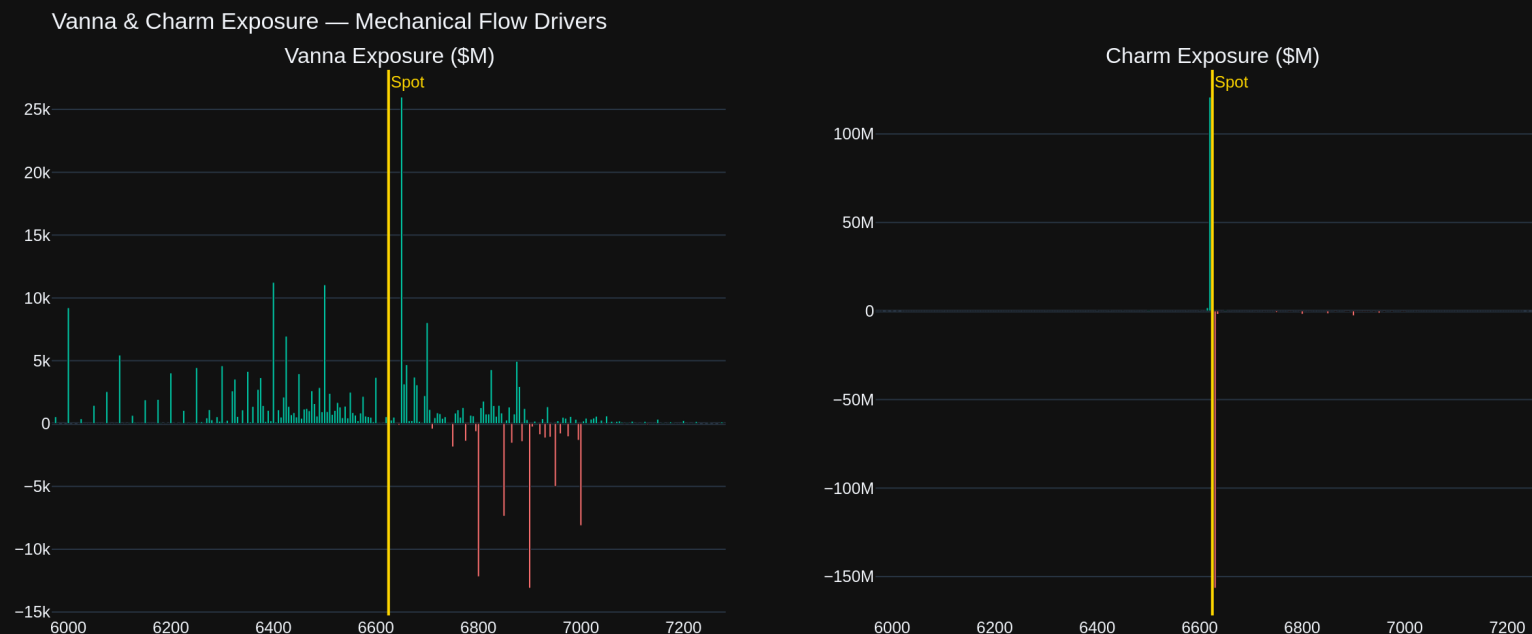
OPEX-SPECIFIC GEX (2026-03-20)

GEX Profile — 2026-03-20 (OPEX Only)



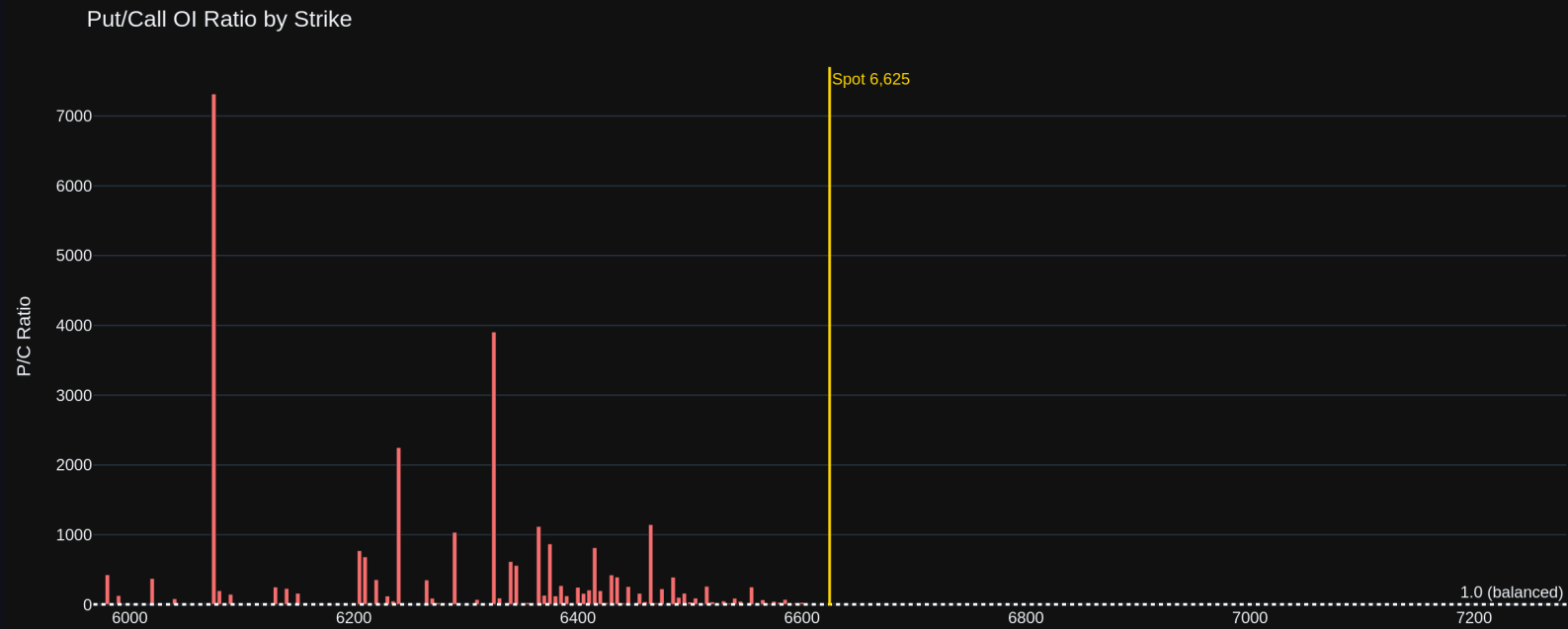
Max Pain: 6,690 — Market tends to gravitate toward max-pain strike in the final trading sessions before OPEX as dealers neutralise hedges.

VANNA & CHARM EXPOSURE



Vanna: $d\Delta/d\sigma$ — when vol changes, dealers re-hedge delta mechanically. Positive vanna = vol compression drives equity buying. **Charm:** $d\Delta/dT$ — daily delta decay creates intraday mechanical flows even without price movement. Strongest near OPEX.

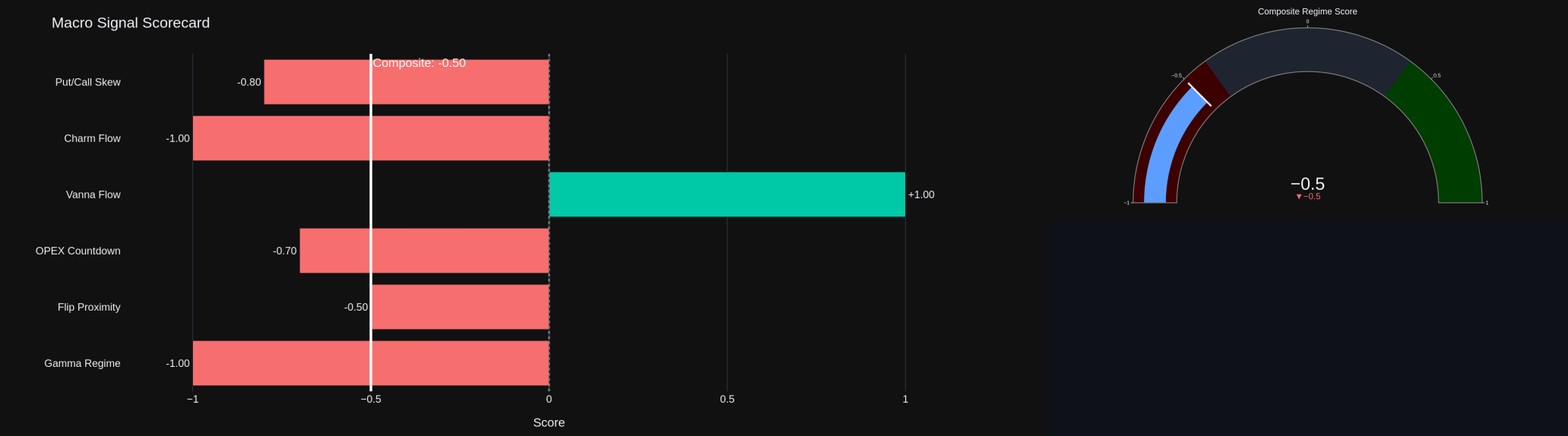
PUT/CALL OI RATIO



Put/Call Ratio: Values above 1.5 signal heavy defensive hedging by institutions. Put walls represent strikes with heavy short-put dealer exposure — dealer delta selling below these levels can accelerate declines.

Macro Signal Dashboard

March 19, 2026



SIGNAL DETAIL

Gamma Regime

BEARISH_VOL_BUY

-1.00

STRONG

Net GEX = \$-3034.37B → dealers are SHORT GAMMA. Spot is 8.8% below gamma flip at 7,205.

- Equities: trending moves more likely, reduce net delta exposure
- Vol: VIX spikes may persist — avoid short vol
- Options: long gamma / straddles for directional flexibility

Flip Proximity

BELOW FLIP: BEARISH

-0.50

MODERATE

Spot (6,625) is 8.8% below gamma flip (7,205). Dealers in short-gamma — trend-following mode, no natural support.

- Watch 7,205 as key inflection — sustained close above = regime shift
- Volatility clustering risk increases near flip

OPEX Countdown

OPEX 1DTE

-0.70

STRONG

OPEX in 1 DTE (CRITICAL urgency). \$-2219831M net GEX expiring = 73.2% of total book. Pin behaviour likely near OPEX strikes.

- Pin risk: market may gravitate to max-pain strike $\pm 0.5\%$ as OPEX approaches
- Post-OPEX: expect vol reset once large GEX concentration expires
- Book impact: 73.2% of dealer delta hedging unwind at OPEX

Vanna Flow

VOL_FALL_BID

+1.00

STRONG

Vanna exposure = \$+178190M. Vol compression → mechanical equity bid via delta re-hedging. VIX 1d change: +1.94 (rising) — diverging with vanna signal.

- Vol decline → dealer delta re-hedging creates systematic equity buying
- Watch VIX 1d direction as leading indicator of vanna flow direction
- Strong positive vanna + falling VIX = powerful mechanical tailwind

Charm Flow

DAILY_DELTA_OUTFLOW

-1.00

STRONG

Charm exposure = \$-24243841M/day. DTE=0: charm acceleration is sharp near expiry. Negative charm = net delta drain as time passes.

- Charm creates mechanical daily delta flows even with no price movement
- Near OPEX, charm accelerates and can distort intraday price action

Put/Call Skew

BEARISH_SKEW_HEAVY

-0.80

STRONG

Put/Call GEX ratio = 1.71. Heavy put protection in dealer books — bearish defensive positioning. Put wall at 6,625 (+0.0% from spot).

- High put skew: dealers short puts → forced to sell into weakness, amplifying downside moves
- Hedging demand exceeds upside speculation — institutional risk-off signal

CROSS-ASSET GEX SUMMARY

INSTRUMENT	SPOT	NET GEX (\$B)	REGIME	FLIP LEVEL	DIST. TO FLIP	CALL WALL	PUT WALL
SPX — S&P 500 Index	6,624.70	-3034.36B	SHORT GAMMA	7,205	-8.8%	6,625	6,625
SPY — SPDR S&P 500 ETF	nan	+0.00B	LONG GAMMA	245	+0.0%	245	245
QQQ — Invesco QQQ ETF	588.50	+22.92B	LONG GAMMA	588	+0.1%	590	570
IWM — iShares Russell 2000 ETF	243.86	+6.88B	LONG GAMMA	243	+0.3%	245	240

⚠ REGIME DIVERGENCE DETECTED — Cross-instrument positioning is mixed. Review individual instrument signals. Example: SPX long-gamma while IWM short-gamma = potential small-cap risk-off signal diverging from large-cap stability.

Cross-instrument divergences often precede sector rotations. When SPX is long-gamma but IWM is short-gamma, institutional flow is concentrated in mega-cap names with less protection in small caps. When QQQ gamma diverges from SPX, watch for tech-driven directional moves.

